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Best Practices on Migration to Progress Application Server (PAS) for OpenEdge

What to expect when implementing PAS for OpenEdge

Chad Thomson

Senior Principal Consultant

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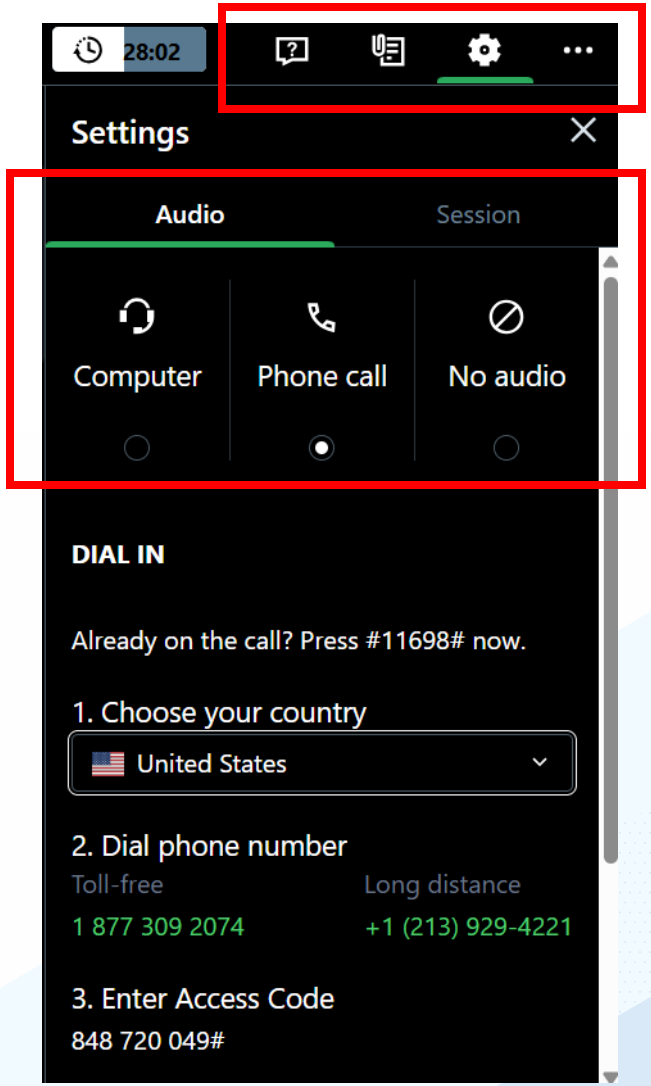

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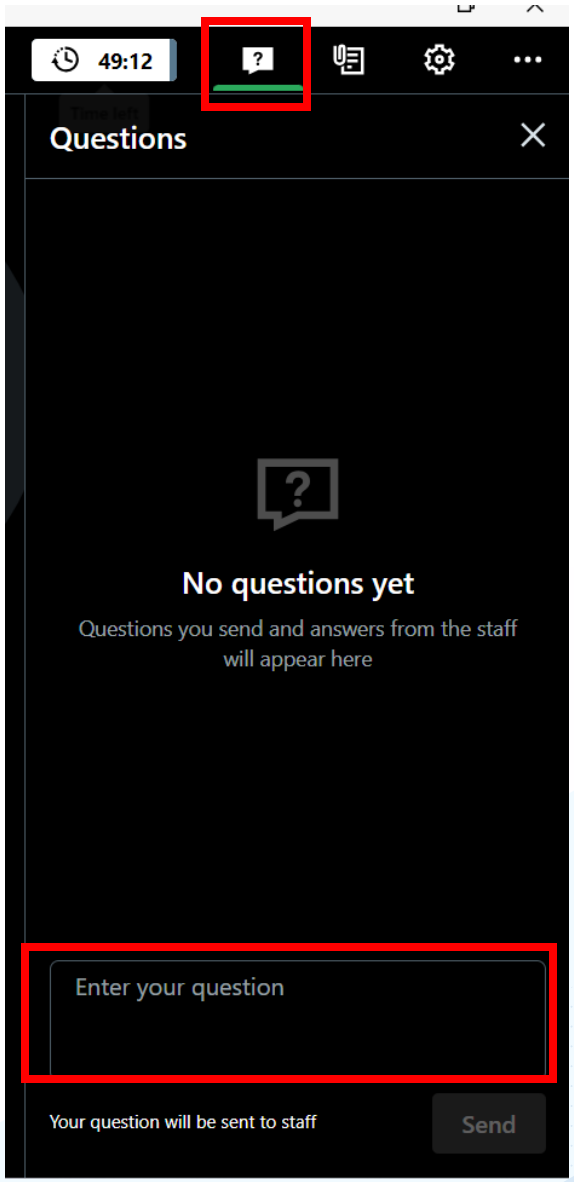

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Chad Thomson

Senior Principal Consultant

- A seasoned software professional with over 25 years of experience delivering creative, innovative solutions to the Progress Community
- Chad is a sought-after international speaker and has been a presenter at numerous Progress and PUG Conferences
- Chad has been providing technical training for over 20 years
- Recognized expert in OpenEdge, Security, CICD, and all things technical

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Webinar Agenda

Architecture Fundamentals

Compare and contrast Classic Broker definitions to PAS for OpenEdge

Planning for Success

Identify the types of activities to make the implementation a success

Considerations and Expectations

Scenarios to consider and to expect

Q&A

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MCP Server for Progress OpenEdge

Make Your OpenEdge Applications AI-Ready

The Progress® OpenEdge® MCP Server is a Model Context Protocol (MCP) Server that connects your trusted OpenEdge business applications to modern AI assistants and agents securely, instantly and without needing to rewrite code.

LEARN MORE

What Is an MCP Server?

An MCP Server is a secure integration layer that allows AI assistants and agents to safely interact w
enterprise applications. Instead of just answering questions, AI can invoke approved business oper
under strict governance using existing APIs and rules.

Key Benefits

- **Fast** — Deploys AI automation within weeks, not months
- **Efficient** — Requires zero custom coding when APIs already exist
- **Ea** — Sim wiz

Progress Agentic RAG for OpenEdge

Unlock the power of your unstructured data with agentic RAG.

REQUEST INFORMATION

Tap the Potential of Your Unstructured Data

Structured data powers your core systems—ERP, PLM, CRM—but it's only part of the story. Nearly 80% of your organization's content is unstructured: documents, emails, videos, images, and more. Without it, decisions lack context. By connecting the Progress® OpenEdge® platform to the new Progress® Agentic RAG solution, users can unlock incredible value from data they already own.

EXPLORE AGENTIC RAG

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Progress OpenEdge MCP Connector for ABL

Accelerate ABL development with AI for the Progress OpenEdge Platform.

The Progress® OpenEdge® MCP Connector for Advanced Business Language (ABL) harnesses AI and domain expertise to accelerate modernization, improve code quality and empower developers—directly in your chosen Integrated Development Environment (IDE).

LEARN MORE

The Challenge

AI is transforming software development, but generic coding assistants aren't equipped for OpenEdge ABL. They produce errors, miss compliance standards and lack the context developers need to modernize successfully, often resulting in delays, more risk and higher costs.

The Solution

The Progress OpenEdge MCP Connector for ABL closes this gap. By combining Generative AI (GenAI) and Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), it delivers domain-specific accuracy, dynamic context-aware coding assistance and scalable modernization, all tailored for OpenEdge development.

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OpenEdge 13.0: The Bridge to the Future

Available February 2026

Key Benefits:

- Build a future-ready foundation
- Enable AI & innovation
- Strengthen security (FIPS 140-3)
- Accelerate modernization
- Boost developer productivity

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LONG-TERM SUPPORT

OpenEdge 12.8

Our latest Long-Term Supported release empowers enterprises to boost developer productivity, streamline environment management and fortify application security, delivering a future-ready foundation for high-performing business applications.

Key Features

- Performance and Tracing Support
- Real-Time Messaging and Streaming
- Data Regulation Support
- .NET 6 Support
- And More!

TRY OPENEDGE 12.8

INNOVATION RELEASE

OpenEdge 13.0

Our latest Innovation release empowers enterprises to adopt new capabilities sooner and sets the foundation for continuous innovation, modernization and security as we move toward the next Long-Term Support (LTS) release.

Key Features

- Initial FIPS 140-3 Support and Updated Cryptographic Libraries
- User-Defined Generics
- Scientific Notation Support
- Threaded Offline Backup and Index Check
- And More!

TRY OPENEDGE 13

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Architecture Fundamentals

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"Experience is something you get just after you need it."

— Steven Wright

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Same questions – better answers

- What is PAS for OpenEdge?
- How does it compare to classic?
- What do the differences mean to me?
- What can I expect from PAS for OpenEdge?
- How do I make sure I have a positive experience implementing PAS for OpenEdge?

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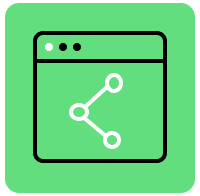
Best Practice - Order of Operations



Structure

Understand PAS for OpenEdge application architecture, deployment model, and how to apply it in your environment

Stability

Ability to accurately rebuild and reconfigure PAS for OpenEdge instances and related applications

Scale

- Monitor for liveness
- Measure metrics
- Adapt to demand

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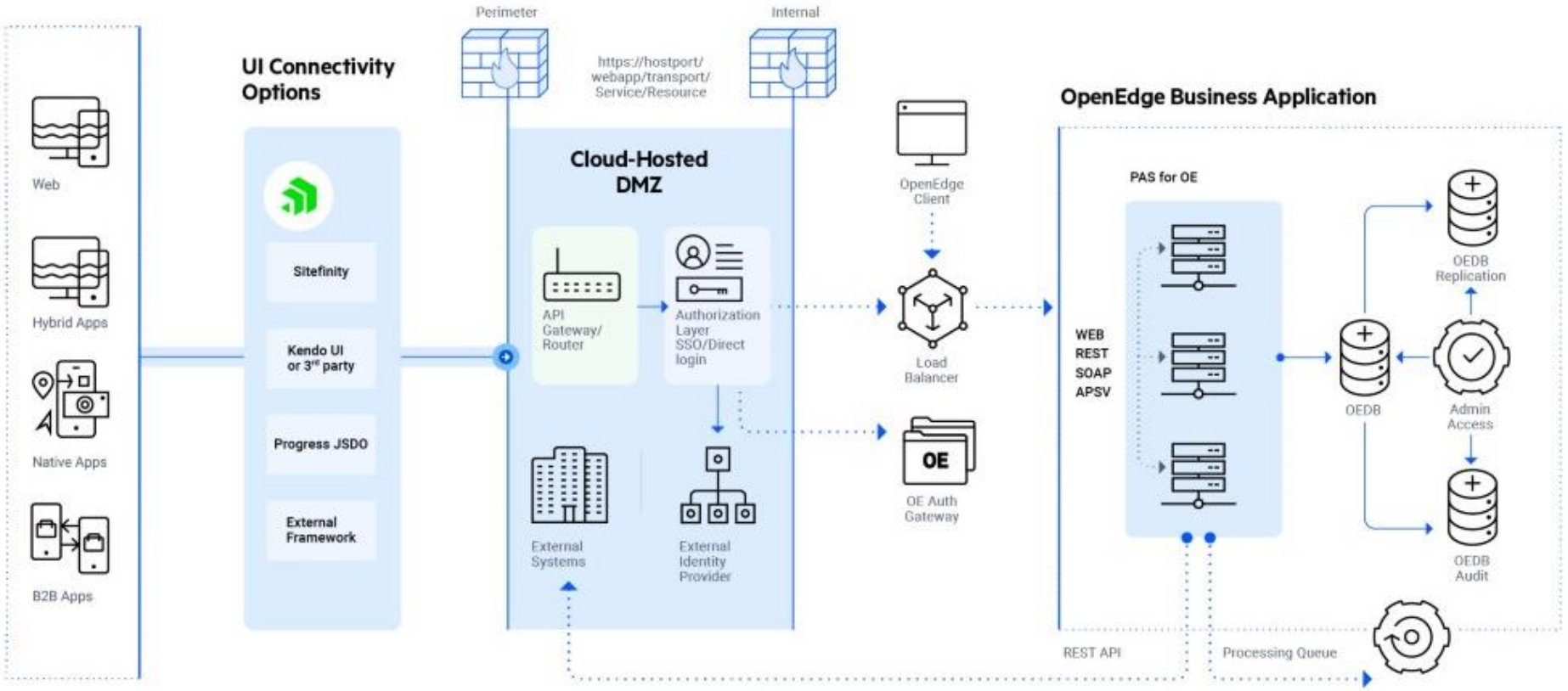

OpenEdge Deployment Infrastructure

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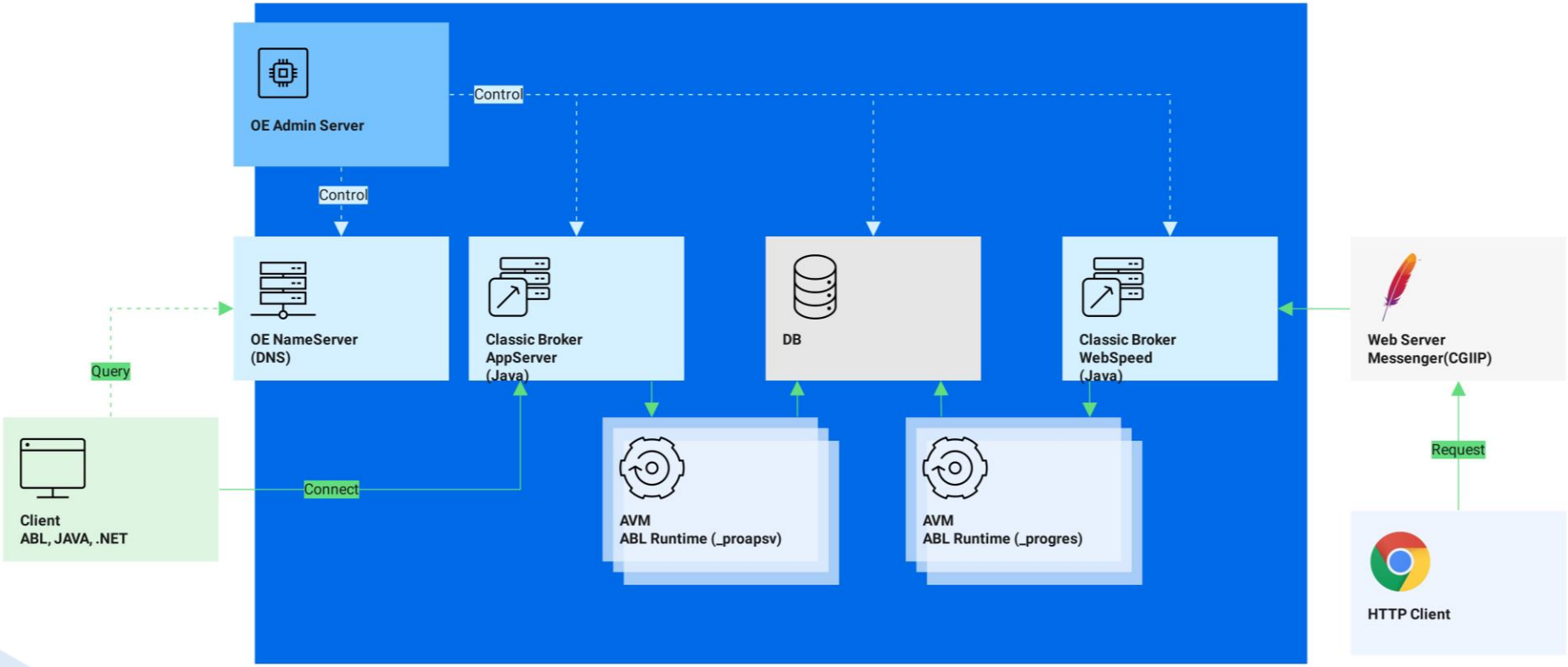

Classic Environment Components

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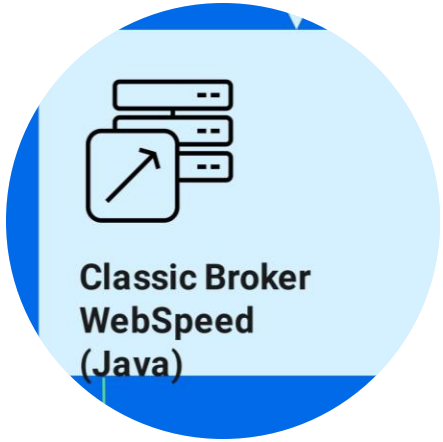
Points of Interest - Classic Broker



OE Admin Server

- Control and configuration of brokers

OE Name Server

- Name lookup service
- Returns IP and Port of registered (named) OE services

Broker

- Java process
- Maintains pool of Agents (runtime AVM)

Agent

- Runtime ABL execution process (AVM)
- One per desired concurrent request

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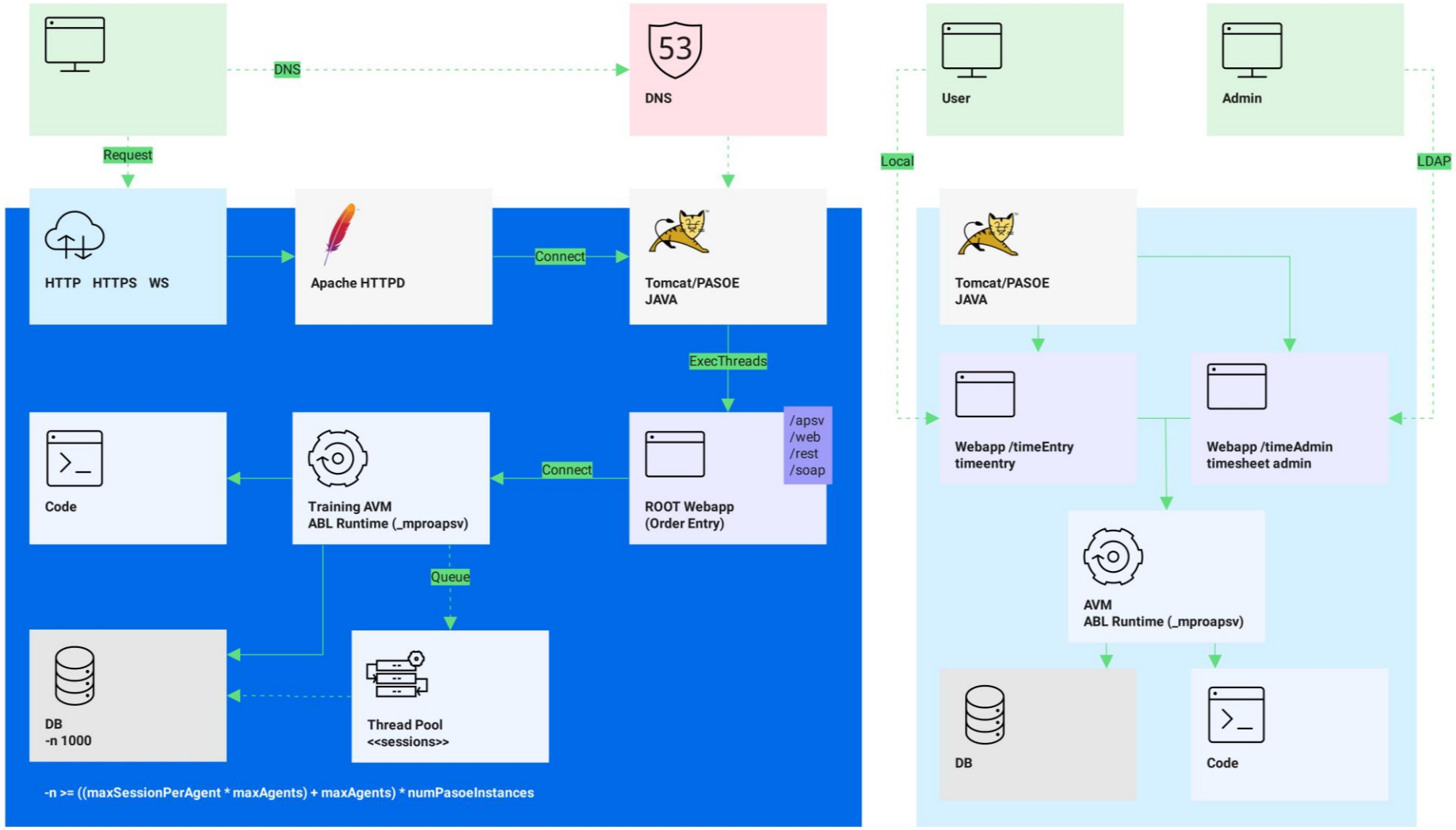
PAS for OpenEdge Service Components



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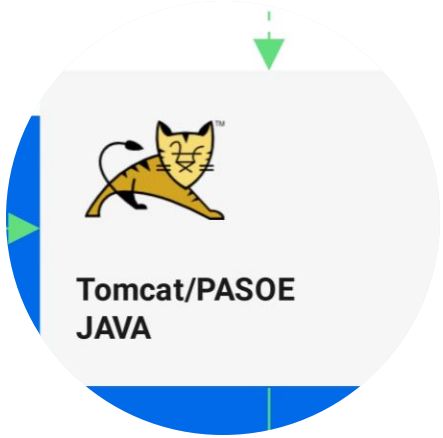
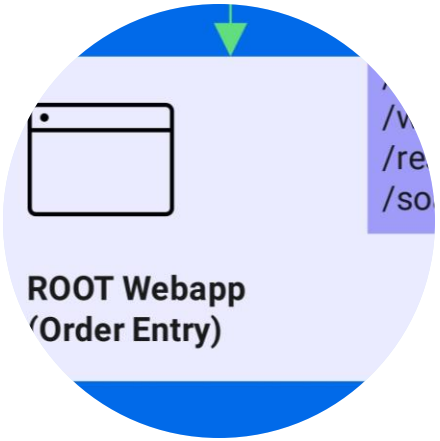
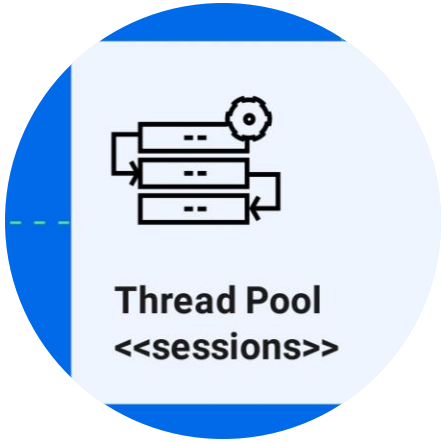
Points of Interest – PAS for OpenEdge Services







Tomcat/PAS

- Heart of the platform
- Customized, extended component s

Webapp

- Individual entry point to AVM configuration
- Security, authentication, RBAC, logging

MT Agent

- Multi-threaded Agent
- Configured AVM runtime
- Multiple AVM Sessions (thread)

Agent Sessions

- One configured agent
- Multiple threads

VS

- Several Agent Processes

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Care and Feeding - Configuration

Classic Broker

Control and Config	Target
Start, Stop, Status	wtbman, asbman
Config Management	mergeprop
Configuration Stored	ubroker.properties

Pro Tip: use DLC/bin/paspropconv to kick-start migrating classic broker definitions to PAS (one-time)

Control and Config	Target
Start,Stop,Status	pasman, tcman
Config Management	oeprop, secprop
Configuration Stored (per-instance, per-webapp)	catalina.properties appserver.properties openedge.properties server.xml oeablSecurity.properties oeablSecurity.csv logging.xml

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Logging – Who doesn't want more logs?

Classic Broker

Source	Target
Broker	broker.log
Agent	agent.log

PAS for OpenEdge

Source	Target (per-instance)
Tomcat	catalina.* <host>.access.*.log
Spring/PAS	<webapp>.*.log <webapp>.authn.log <webapp>.authz.log
Agent	<webapp>.agent.*.log

Pro Tip: fine-tune ABL logging using the OE Logging framework, available in OpenEdge.Core.pl

- Start in <webapp>/WEB-INF/logging.xml
- Identify what area needs the logging changes
  - Tomcat – for high-level access info (start/stop)
  - Spring/PAS – Java, internal workings
  - Agent – typical "**" or ABL event messages

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Planning for Success

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"Experience is what you gain when things don't go according to plan."

— unknown (sounds like me, though)

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Evaluate your application environment

Network

- Identify firewalls between service consumers (clients) and brokers
- Have a network layout diagram that demonstrates end-to-end communication path

Classic Services

- Identify broker definitions, configuration, and codebase

Known Clients

- Identify clients to existing services and how they interact

Ancillary Services

- Identify external or third-party applications that may be accessing your services (e.g. external REST clients, open client)

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Evaluate your operations

Wants, Needs

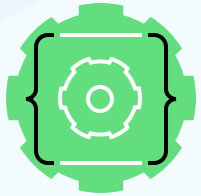
- Are current processes critical to operation?
- Are there aspects that haven't been considered?

Application Source

- Inventory application assets - entirety
- Evaluate code - **be honest**
- Expect changes - **make them**
- Cleanly rebuild your application

Owners

- Who does what, and when?
- Get SME involvement
- Agree on metrics for success
- Include launch go/no-go



Target Goals

- What is your authentication and authorization strategy?
- Do you need end-to-end TLS?

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"If everything goes right, we get a good experience. If everything goes wrong, we get a good story."

— Simon Sinek

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Critically evaluate progression

Still, Be Honest

Test, Test, Test some more

Deploy, tear-down, deploy

Concurrent load testing

Test for failure and recovery

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Considerations and Expectations

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"The secret to success is having ~~low~~ realistic expectations"

— Warren Buffett (original)

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Classic Broker Migration

AppServer

Service Type	Expectation, Result
REST, SOAP	Service URI will be very similar [<service>]/rest/<resource> [<service>]/soap/<resource> Re-use classic .paar, .wsm definitions For full control of REST swap-out to WebDataObject implementation
AIA	URI Transition from /aia to /apsv
ABL, OpenClient	Update connection string -URL https://.../apsv Client dictates session model, add -session-Model state-free

WebSpeed

Service	Expectation, Result
Uses Messenger	Manage URI mapping to /web/ transport
Application uses Mapped-HTML model	Re-implement with webhandler classes
CGIWrapper code	Need to use CompatibilityWebHandler Reimplement using webhandler classes
Application has references to full URI	Change to using paths relative to /web/ transport
Static Assets, where do they go?	PAS can host in /WEB-INF/static/ folder Host in DMZ or on CDN

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PRO TIP: Keep track of your instances

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1			Ports					
2	Instance Name	Location	HTTPS	HTTP	AJP	Health	AgentMin	AgentMax
3	instance1	/srv/instance1	8700	8701	8702	8703		
4								
5	instance2	/srv/appinst2	8800	8801	8802	8803		
6								
7								
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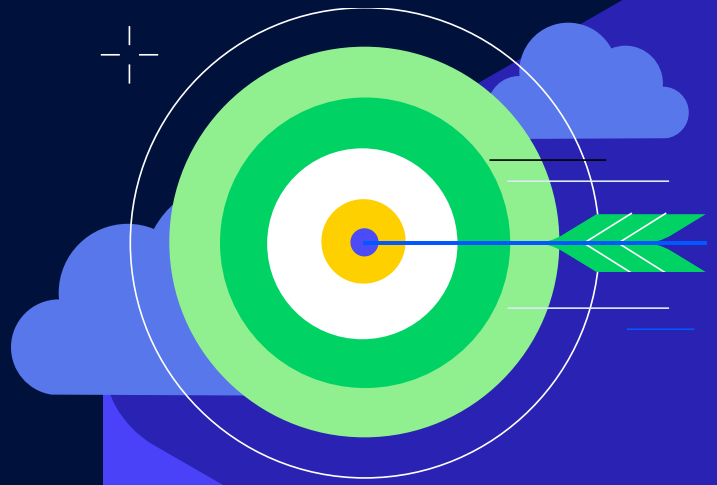

Pro Tip #2: use -1 for the shutdown port

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Target Production - today

- Start now - *Practice the way you play*
- Use CLI instance tooling pasman, tcman
- Create instances using "-Z prod"
- Learn to recognize which component requires your focus
  - Tomcat
  - Spring (security, RBAC)
  - PAS Classes (session manager, logging)
  - Agent (ABL code, "**" errors)

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Secure by default, Features are Opt-in

Opt-in early – at development time

- Enable HTTPS transport
- Create and manage SSL/TLS certificates
- Script certificate management
- Let's Encrypt + certbot

- Let Spring manage Authentication and URI RBAC
- Application code should focus on Authorization

- Integrate with authentication services
  - OAuth2/OIDC
  - LDAP/AD
  - OpenEdge Authentication Gateway

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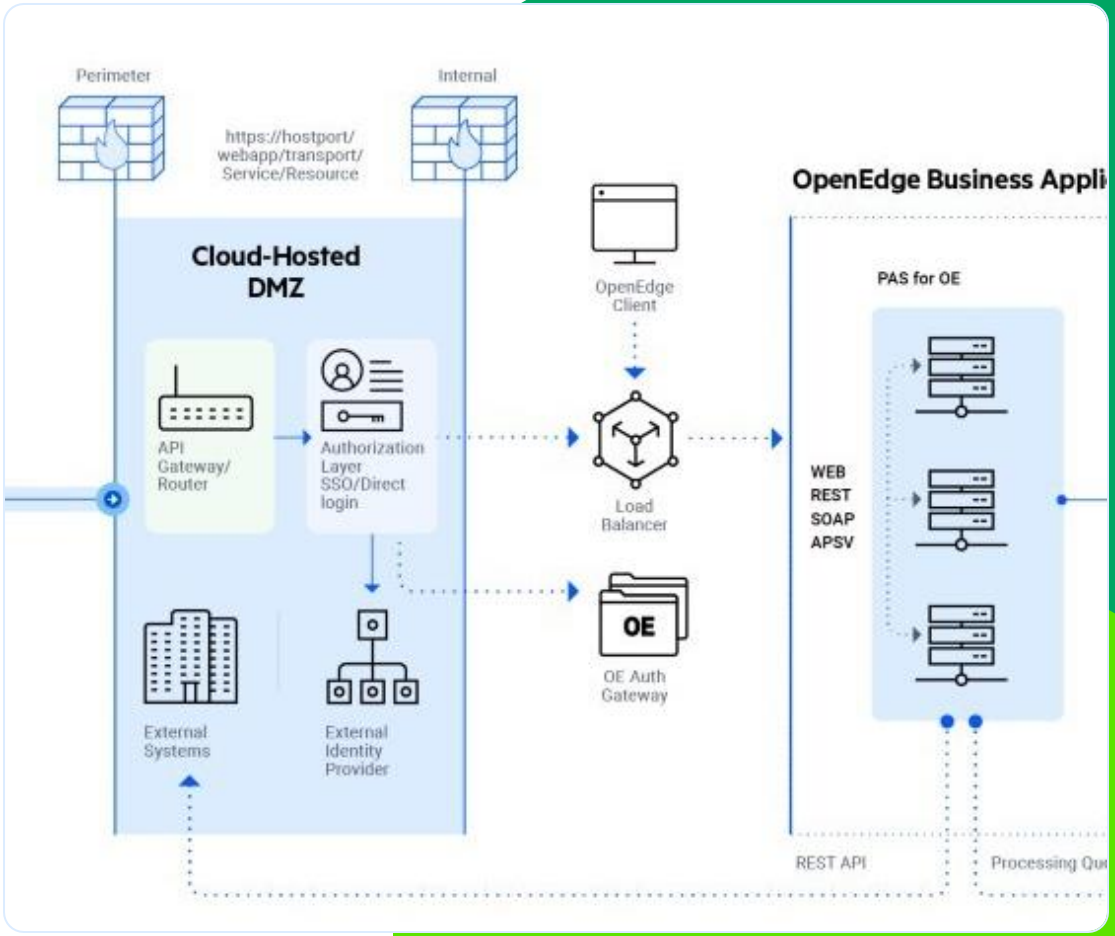
Pro Tip: Reverse Proxy

- First step into a larger world
- Cannot 'scale' without one
- Eases configuration
- May improve application responsiveness
- Load balancing, caching, routing
- Apache HTTPD
- Nginx
- Traefik, AWS ALB



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Thanks for attending

Here's to having a successful PAS for OpenEdge experience.

Presentation slides and configuration examples available on GitHub

https://chadthomsonpsc.github.io/webinar-pasoe-migration-2026/

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Q&A

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